

— FREE GUIDE · @OLLIERDZ



Markdown Quick-Start

Write formatted text in seconds — and use it everywhere. Set up an editor, learn the 9 symbols that matter, done.

```
# your first file
# Hello world
This is markdown — and it just works.
```

— STEP 1

Make your first .md file

You don't install Markdown — it's just text. You only need somewhere to type it.

The 30-second version:

1. Open any text editor (even Notepad / TextEdit).
2. Type a line: `# My notes`
3. Save the file as `notes.md` (not `.txt`).

That **.md** ending tells other apps "read this as Markdown." On its own it's still plain text — the magic shows when an app **preview**s it (next step).

Install a proper editor

To **see** your Markdown render live, use one of these free apps. Pick one:

 **Obsidian** — best for notes

Download at obsidian.md. Type Markdown, see it formatted instantly. Free.

 **VS Code** — best for projects

Get it at code.visualstudio.com. Open any `.md` and press **Ctrl/Cmd + Shift + V** for a live preview.

 **Nothing to install** — quickest

Paste Markdown straight into **GitHub**, **Notion**, or **Claude** — they all render it automatically.

The 9 symbols that matter

# Big title · ## Smaller	Big title
bold	bold
<i>*italic*</i>	<i>italic</i>
- bullet item	• bullet item
1. numbered item	1. numbered item
[text](https://url)	<u>text</u>
`code`	<code>code</code>
> quote	quote
- [] task · - [x] done	☐ task ☒ done

Where to use it

README.md — the front page of any GitHub repo. First thing people read.

SKILL.md — how you teach Claude a new skill.

Notes — Obsidian & Notion are built on Markdown.

AI prompts — structure your prompts with headings & lists; models love it.

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